

▽ **Stepan Razin** heading for execution



1671

COSSACK REVOLT DEFEATED

The Cossacks were independent peoples living on the borders of the Russian Empire. From 1667, a Don Cossack, Stepan “Stenka” Razin, led an armed band on a rampage around the Volga River and the Caspian Sea. As rebellious Russian peasants flocked to join him, Razin threatened the Russian state. The well-trained imperial army defeated the Cossacks and crushed the peasant uprising. Captured, Razin was dismembered in Moscow’s Red Square in June 1671.

1670

1671 Angola is conquered as the Portuguese take over the Kingdom of Ndongo

1670 England establishes the Hudson’s Bay Company to trade in Canada

1672

ENGLISH SLAVE TRADE GROWS

The Royal African Company of England, established in 1672, was a venture backed by the Stuart monarchy to promote trade on the West African coast, chiefly the transport of enslaved Africans to British colonies in the New World. Wealthy figures, such as Bristol merchant Edward Colston, joined in the Company’s activities. Other European countries engaged in the transatlantic slave trade, with Britain becoming the main trader.



△ **Edward Colston**, portrait by Jonathan Richardson

By 1740, some 42,000 enslaved Africans were transported in British ships every year